1. When may you stop on the hard shoulder of a motorway?

A. Only in an emergency

B. If you feel tired and need to rest

C. If you've gone past your exit

D. To answer your mobile phone

2. You're riding on the motorway. Where should you position your motorcycle well before you reach your exit slip-road?

A. In the middle lane

B. In the left-hand lane

C. On the hard shoulder

D. In any lane

3. What should you do if you're joining a motorway from a slip road?

A. Adjust your speed to match the speed of the traffic on the motorway

B. Accelerate as quickly as you can and ride straight out

C. Ride onto the hard shoulder until a gap appears

D. Expect drivers on the motorway to give way to you

4. What's the minimum engine size your motorcycle must have, if you want to ride it on the motorway?

A. 50 cc

B. 125 cc

C. 150 cc

D. 250 cc

5. You're riding at 70 mph on a three-lane motorway. Which lane should you use if there's no traffic ahead?

A. Any lane

B. The middle lane

C. The right-hand lane

D. The left-hand lane

6. You're riding on a motorway. Unless signs show otherwise, what's the national speed limit?

A. 50 mph

B. 60 mph

C. 70 mph

D. 80 mph

7. Why is it particularly important to carry out a check of your motorcycle before making a long motorway journey?

A. You'll have to do more harsh braking on motorways

B. Motorway service stations don't deal with breakdowns

C. The road surface will wear down the tyres faster

D. Continuous high speeds increase the risk of your motorcycle breaking down

8. You're joining a motorway from a slip road. How should you deal with traffic already on the motorway?

A. Stop at the end of the slip road and look for a safe gap

B. Match your speed to traffic in the left-hand lane and filter into a safe gap

C. Use the slip road to accelerate until you're moving much faster than the motorway traffic

D. Carry on along the hard shoulder until you see a safe gap

9. What's the national speed limit on motorways for cars and motorcycles?

A. 70 mph

B. 30 mph

C. 50 mph

D. 60 mph

10. Which vehicles should use the left-hand lane on a three-lane motorway?

A. Emergency vehicles only

B. Any vehicle that isn't overtaking

C. Large vehicles only

D. Slow vehicles only

11. Which vehicles aren't allowed to use the right-hand lane of a three-lane motorway?

A. Motorcycle and sidecar outfits

B. Small delivery vans

C. Motorcycles

D. Vehicles towing a trailer

12. Your vehicle breaks down on a motorway and you need to call for help. Why might it be better to use an emergency roadside telephone rather than a mobile phone?

A. It connects you to a local garage

B. Mobile phones don't work on motorways

C. It allows easy location by the emergency services

D. Using a mobile phone will distract other drivers

13. Your vehicle broke down on the hard shoulder of a motorway, but has now been repaired. How should you rejoin the main carriageway?

A. Wait on the hard shoulder until someone flashes their headlights at you

B. Move out onto the carriageway using your hazard warning lights

C. Move out onto the carriageway, then build up your speed

D. Gain speed on the hard shoulder before moving out onto the carriageway

14. You're travelling along a motorway. Where would you find a crawler or climbing lane?



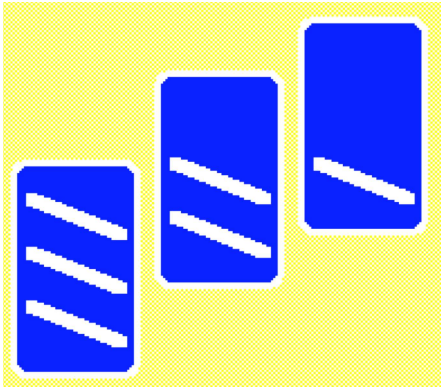
A. Along the hard shoulder

B. Before a service area

C. On a steep gradient

D. Before a junction

15. What do these motorway signs mean?



A. They're distance markers to the next telephone

B. They warn of a police control ahead

C. They're countdown markers to the next exit

D. They're countdown markers to a bridge

16. Where are amber reflective studs found on a motorway?

A. Between the hard shoulder and the carriageway

B. Between the acceleration lane and the carriageway

C. Between the central reservation and the carriageway

D. Between each pair of lanes

17. What colour are the reflective studs between the lanes on a motorway?

A. Red

B. White

C. Amber

D. Green

18. What colour are the reflective studs between a motorway and a slip road?

A. White

B. Amber

C. Green

D. Red

19. Your vehicle has broken down on a motorway. In which direction should you walk to find the nearest emergency telephone?

A. With the traffic flow

B. Facing oncoming traffic

C. In the direction shown on the marker posts

D. In the direction of the nearest exit

20. Why is it important to make full use of the slip road as you join a motorway?

A. Because there's space available to turn round if you need to

B. Because you can continue on the hard shoulder

C. To allow you to fit safely into the traffic flow in the left-hand lane

D. To allow you direct access to the overtaking lanes

21. How should you position yourself when you use the emergency telephone on a motorway?

A. Stay close to the carriageway

B. Face the oncoming traffic

C. Keep your back to the traffic

D. Stand on the hard shoulder

22. What colour are the reflective studs between the hard shoulder and the left-hand lane of a motorway?

A. Green

B. Red

C. White

D. Amber

23. On a three-lane motorway, which lane should you use if there's no traffic ahead?

A. Left

B. Right

C. Centre

D. Either the right or centre

24. What should you do when going through a contraflow system on a motorway?



A. Switch lanes to keep the traffic flowing

B. Use dipped headlights

C. Keep a good distance from the vehicle ahead

D. Stay close to the vehicle ahead to reduce queues

25. You're on a three-lane motorway. Which lane are you in if there are red reflective studs on your left and white ones to your right?

A. In the right-hand lane

B. In the middle lane

C. On the hard shoulder

D. In the left-hand lane

26. What should you do when you're approaching roadworks on a motorway?

A. Stay very close to the vehicle in front

B. Speed up to clear the area quickly

C. Always use the hard shoulder

D. Obey the speed limit

27. Which vehicles are prohibited from using the motorway?

A. Double-deck buses

B. Motorcycles over 50 cc

C. Cars with automatic transmission

D. Powered mobility scooters

28. What should you do while you're driving or riding along a motorway?

A. Maintain a shorter separation distance than you would on other roads

B. Look much further ahead than you would on other roads

C. Travel much faster than you would on other roads

D. Concentrate more than you would on other roads

29. What should you do immediately after joining a motorway?

A. Stay in the left-hand lane

B. Try to overtake

C. Re-adjust your mirrors

D. Position your vehicle in the centre lane

30. When would you use the right-hand lane on a three-lane motorway?

A. When you're overtaking

B. When you're trying to save fuel

C. When you're travelling above the speed limit

D. When you're turning right

31. You're on a motorway. The hard shoulder is not being used as a running lane. When should you use the hard shoulder?

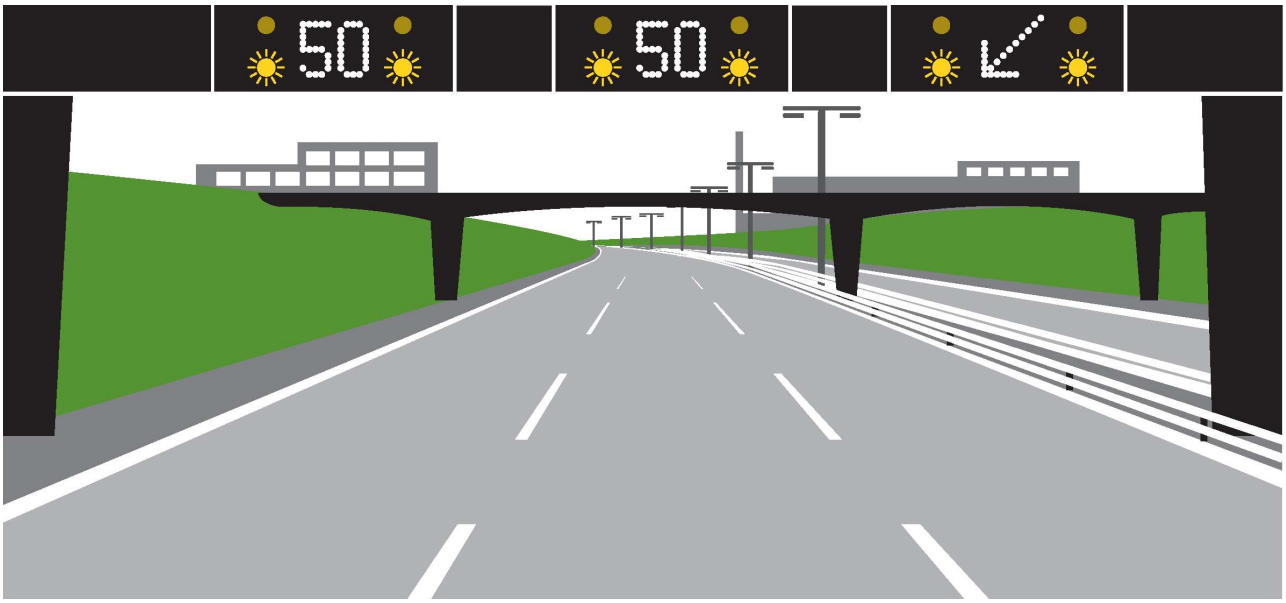
A. When you're joining the motorway

B. When you're stopping in an emergency

C. When you're leaving the motorway

D. When you're stopping for a rest

32. You're in the right-hand lane of a three-lane motorway. What do these overhead signs mean?



A. Use the hard shoulder until you've passed the hazard

B. Move to the left and reduce your speed to 50 mph

C. There are roadworks 50 metres (55 yards) ahead

D. Leave the motorway at the next exit

33. When are you allowed to stop on a motorway?

A. When you're signalled to do so by traffic signals

B. When you need to walk and get fresh air

C. When you wish to pick up hitchhikers

D. When you need to use a mobile telephone

34. You're travelling in the left-hand lane of a three-lane motorway. How should you react to traffic joining from a slip road?

A. Maintain a steady speed

B. Increase your speed to ensure they join behind you

C. Adjust your speed or change lane if you can do so safely

D. Switch on your hazard warning lights

35. How should you use the lanes on a motorway?

A. Use the lane that has the least traffic

B. Keep to the left-hand lane unless you're overtaking

C. Overtake using the lane that’s clearest

D. Stay in one lane until you reach your exit

36. You're travelling along a motorway. When are you allowed to overtake on the left?

A. When in queues and traffic to your right is moving more slowly than you are

B. When you can see well ahead that the hard shoulder is clear

C. When the traffic in the right-hand lane is signalling right

D. When you warn drivers behind by signalling left

37. When would you use an emergency area on a motorway?

A. In cases of emergency or breakdown

B. To make a private phone call

C. To stop and check where you are

D. If you think you'll be involved in a road rage incident

38. Traffic officers operate on motorways and some primary routes in England and Wales. What are they authorised to do?



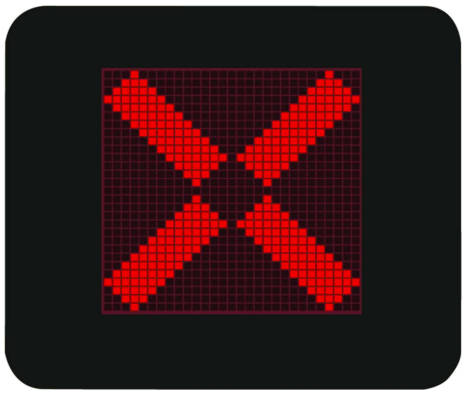
A. Stop and arrest drivers who break the law

B. Repair broken-down vehicles on the motorway

C. Issue fixed penalty notices

D. Stop and direct anyone on a motorway

39. You're on a motorway. What does it mean when a red cross is displayed above the hard shoulder?



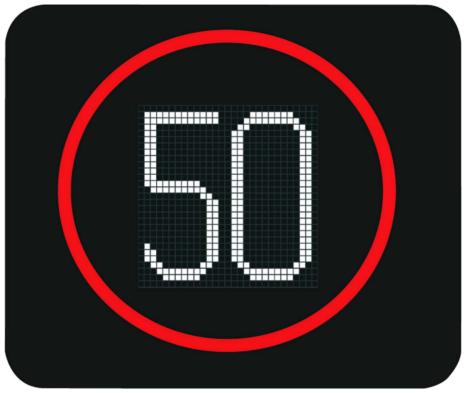
A. You must not travel in this lane

B. This lane can be used if you need a rest

C. Use this lane as a running lane

D. Pull up in this lane to answer your mobile phone

40. You're on a motorway. What does it mean when a mandatory speed limit is displayed above the hard shoulder?



A. You can pull up in this lane to answer a mobile phone

B. You can park on the hard shoulder if you feel tired

C. The hard shoulder can be used as a running lane

D. You shouldn't travel in this lane

41. How do motorways reduce traffic bunching?

A. By using variable speed limits

B. By using higher speed limits

C. By using advisory speed limits

D. By using minimum speed limits

42. What helps to reduce traffic bunching on a motorway?

A. National speed limits

B. Variable speed limits

C. Contraflow systems

D. Lane closures

43. When may you stop on a motorway?

A. If you have to read a map

B. When you're tired and need a rest

C. If your mobile phone rings

D. In an emergency or breakdown

44. What's the national speed limit for a car or motorcycle on a motorway?

A. 80 mph

B. 50 mph

C. 60 mph

D. 70 mph

45. You stop on the hard shoulder of a motorway and use the emergency telephone. Where's the best place to wait for help to arrive?

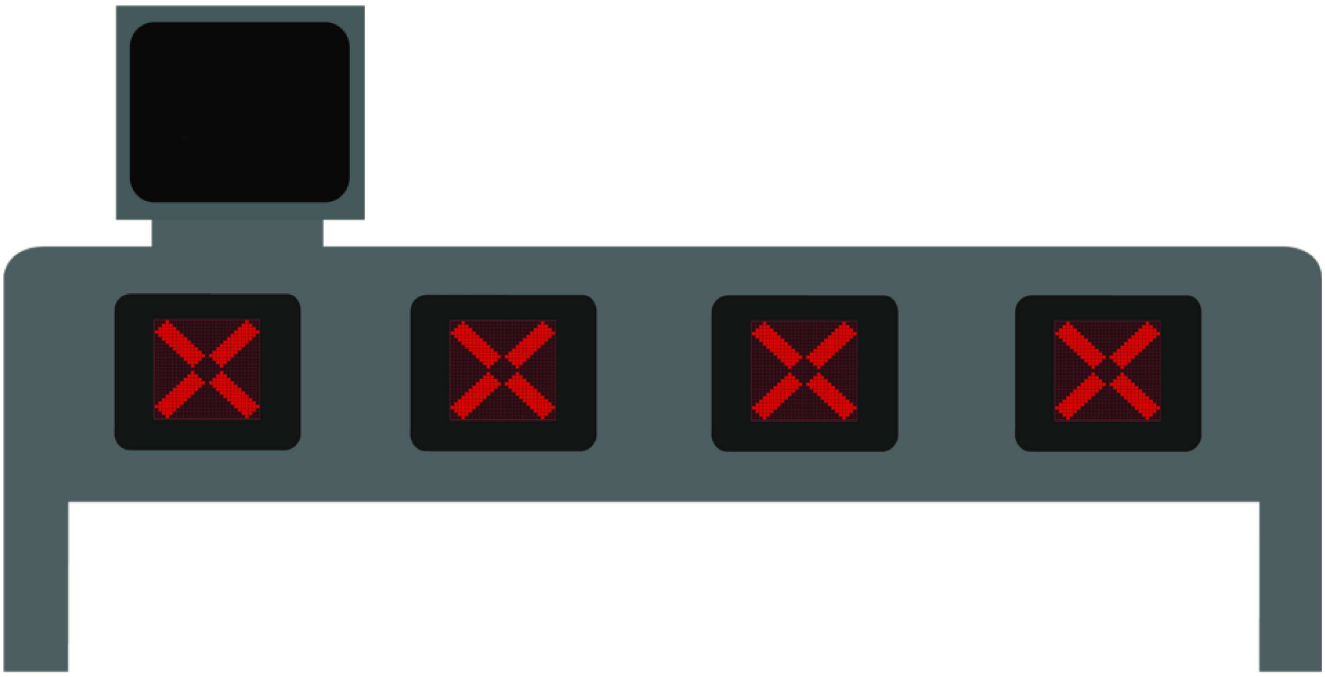
A. Next to the phone

B. Well away from the carriageway

C. With your vehicle

D. On the hard shoulder

46. You're on a motorway. What must you do if there's a red cross showing above every lane?



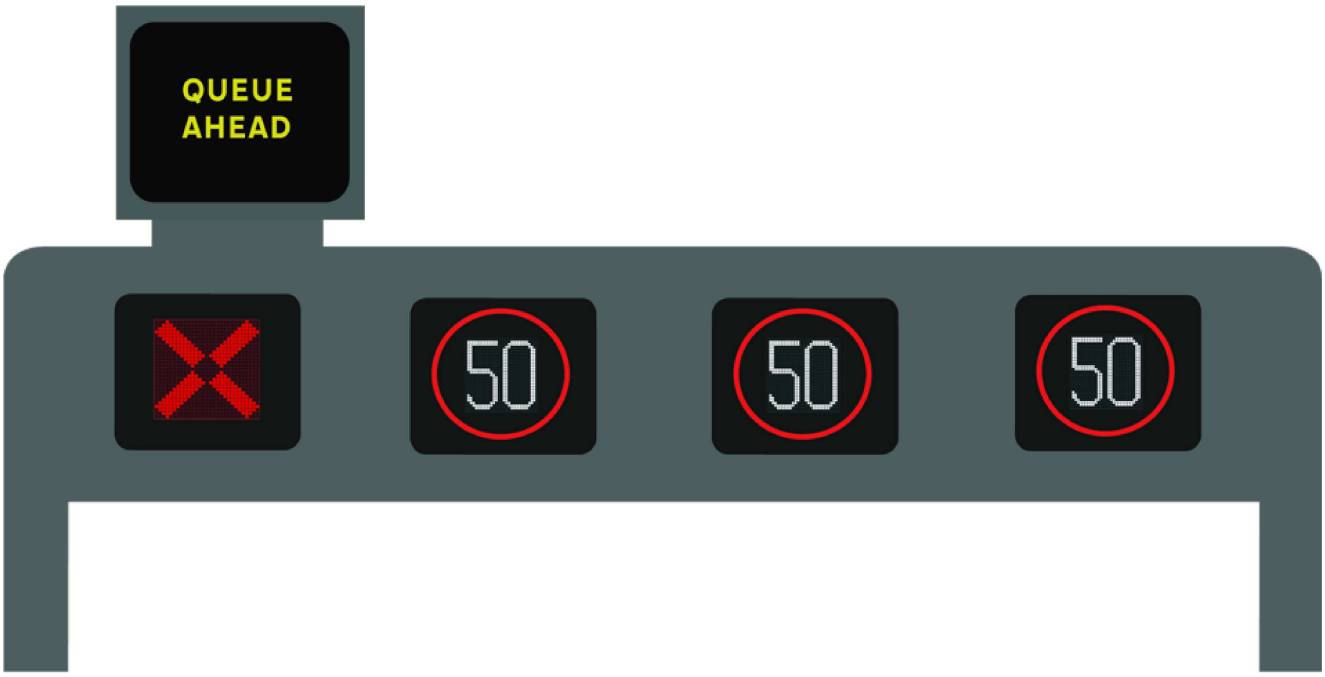
A. Pull onto the hard shoulder

B. Slow down and watch for further signals

C. Leave at the next exit

D. Stop and wait

47. You're on a motorway. What does it mean if a red cross is showing above the hard shoulder and mandatory speed limits above all other lanes?



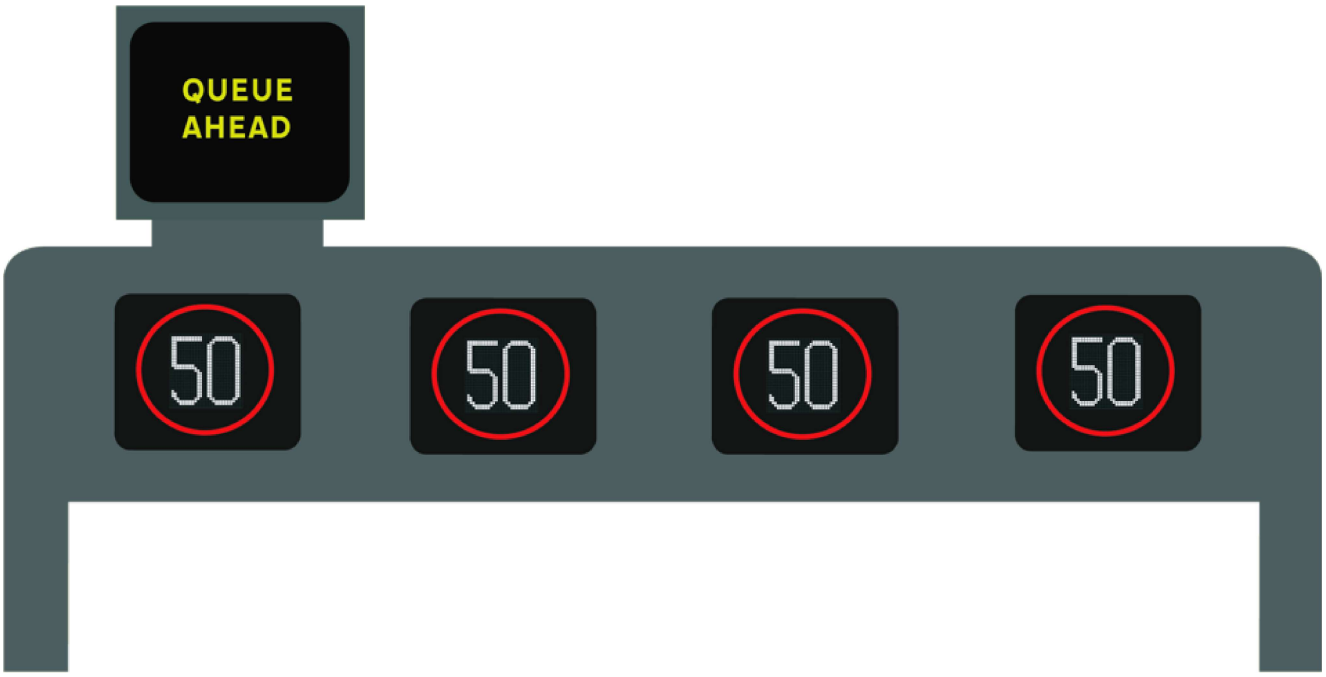
A. The hard shoulder can be used as a rest area if you feel tired

B. The hard shoulder is for emergency or breakdown use only

C. The hard shoulder can be used as a normal running lane

D. The hard shoulder has a speed limit of 50 mph

48. What does this motorway sign mean?



A. Use the hard shoulder only

B. Use all the lanes, including the hard shoulder

C. Use any lane except the hard shoulder

D. Use the three right-hand lanes only

49. Where should you stop to rest if you feel tired while you're travelling along a motorway?

A. On the central reservation

B. On a slip road

C. At the nearest service area

D. On the hard shoulder

50. You have stopped in an emergency area. What must you do before you rejoin the carriageway?

A. Move away with your hazard lights on

B. Switch on your vehicle's headlights

C. Give an arm signal as you are moving off

D. Use the emergency telephone

51. How should you rejoin the motorway after a breakdown on the hard shoulder?

A. Keep your hazard lights flashing until you have safely rejoined the carriageway

B. Wait until a vehicle in the left-hand lane signals to you that it's safe to rejoin

C. Build up speed on the hard shoulder before looking for a safe gap in the traffic

D. Move straight out into the left-hand lane as you are not allowed to drive on the hard shoulder

Answers

1. A - Only in an emergency

You mustn't stop on the hard shoulder, except in an emergency or when your motorcycle breaks down. If the hard shoulder is in use as a running lane, try to reach an emergency area or take the next exit. Never use the hard shoulder to have a rest or a picnic, answer a mobile phone or check a road map.

2. B - In the left-hand lane

You'll see the first advance direction sign one mile from a motorway exit. If you're travelling at 60 mph, you'll only have about 50 seconds before you reach the countdown markers. There'll be another sign at the half-mile point. Move to the left-hand lane in good time. Don't cut across traffic at the last moment and don't risk missing your exit.

3. A - Adjust your speed to match the speed of the traffic on the motorway

Give way to vehicles that are already on the motorway, and join the left-hand lane when there's a suitable gap in the traffic. Don't expect traffic on the motorway to give way to you, but try to avoid stopping at the end of the slip road.

4. A - 50 cc

Riders of motorcycles with an engine smaller than 50 cc aren't allowed to use motorways, due to their restricted speed. They may cause a hazard – both for the rider and for drivers of other vehicles.

5. D - The left-hand lane

If you're not overtaking, use the left-hand lane regardless of the speed at which you're travelling.

6. C - 70 mph

The national speed limit of 70 mph applies to cars and motorcycles on the motorway, unless they're towing a trailer. This speed limit can be reduced and signs will show the new speed limit inside a red circle.

7. D - Continuous high speeds increase the risk of your motorcycle breaking down

Before starting a motorway journey, make sure your motorcycle can cope with the demands of high-speed riding. Things you need to check include oil, water, tyres and fuel. When you're travelling a long way, it's a good idea to plan rest stops in advance.

8. B - Match your speed to traffic in the left-hand lane and filter into a safe gap

You should give way to traffic already on the motorway. Where possible, traffic may move over to let you in, but don’t force your way into the traffic stream. Traffic could be travelling at high speed, so try to match your speed to filter in without affecting the traffic flow.

9. A - 70 mph

Travelling at the national speed limit doesn't allow you to hog the right-hand lane. Always use the left-hand lane whenever possible. When leaving a motorway, get into the left-hand lane well before your exit. Reduce your speed on the slip road and look out for sharp bends or curves and traffic queuing at roundabouts.

10. B - Any vehicle that isn't overtaking

On a motorway, all traffic should use the left-hand lane unless overtaking. When overtaking a number of slower vehicles, move back to the left-hand lane when you’re safely past. Check your mirrors frequently and don’t stay in the middle or right-hand lane if the left-hand lane is free.

11. D - Vehicles towing a trailer

On the motorway, any vehicle towing a trailer is restricted to 60 mph. It’s not allowed in the right-hand lane, as it might hold up faster-moving traffic that wishes to overtake in that lane.

12. C - It allows easy location by the emergency services

On a motorway, it's best to use a roadside emergency telephone so that the emergency services are able to find you easily. The location of the nearest telephone is shown by an arrow on marker posts at the edge of the hard shoulder. If you use a mobile, find out the number on the nearest marker post before you call. This number will let the operator know where you are and in which direction you're travelling.

13. D - Gain speed on the hard shoulder before moving out onto the carriageway

Signal your intention and build up sufficient speed on the hard shoulder so that you can filter into a safe gap in the traffic. Don't push your way into a small gap or cause other traffic to alter speed or direction.

14. C - On a steep gradient

Large, slow-moving vehicles can hinder the progress of other traffic. On a steep gradient, an extra crawler lane may be provided for slow-moving vehicles to allow faster-moving traffic to flow more easily.

15. C - They're countdown markers to the next exit

The exit from a motorway is indicated by countdown markers. These are positioned 90 metres (100 yards) apart, the first being 270 metres (300 yards) from the start of the slip road. Move into the left-hand lane well before you reach the start of the slip road.

16. C - Between the central reservation and the carriageway

On motorways, reflective studs of various colours are fixed in the road between the lanes. These help you to identify which lane you're in when it's dark or in poor visibility. Amber-coloured studs are found on the right-hand edge of the main carriageway, next to the central reservation.

17. B - White

White studs are found between the lanes on motorways. They reflect back the light from your headlights. This is especially useful in bad weather, when visibility is restricted.

18. C - Green

The studs between the carriageway and the hard shoulder are normally red. These change to green where there's a slip road, helping you to identify slip roads when visibility is poor or when it's dark.

19. C - In the direction shown on the marker posts

Along the hard shoulder there are marker posts at 100-metre intervals. These will direct you to the nearest emergency telephone.

20. C - To allow you to fit safely into the traffic flow in the left-hand lane

Try to join the motorway without affecting the progress of the traffic in the left-hand lane and always give way to traffic already on the motorway. At busy times, you may have to slow down to merge into slow-moving traffic.

21. B - Face the oncoming traffic

Traffic is passing you at speed. If the draught from a large lorry catches you by surprise, it could blow you off balance and even onto the carriageway. By facing the oncoming traffic, you can see approaching lorries and so be prepared for their draught. You'll also be in a position to see any other hazards approaching.

22. B - Red

Red studs are placed between the edge of the carriageway and the hard shoulder. Where slip roads leave or join the motorway, the studs are green.

23. A - Left

On a three-lane motorway, you should travel in the left-hand lane unless you’re overtaking. This applies regardless of the speed at which you’re travelling.

24. C - Keep a good distance from the vehicle ahead

At roadworks, and especially where a contraflow system is operating, a speed restriction is likely to be in place. Keep to the lower speed limit and don’t • switch lanes • get too close to the vehicle in front of you. Be aware that there will be no permanent barrier between you and the oncoming traffic.

25. D - In the left-hand lane

The colours of the reflective studs on the motorway and their locations are • red – between the hard shoulder and the carriageway • white – between lanes • amber – between the carriageway and the central reservation • green – along slip-road exits and entrances • bright green/yellow – at roadworks and contraflow systems.

26. D - Obey the speed limit

Be aware of reduced speed limits at roadworks. Speed limits shown inside a red circle are mandatory and cameras are often used to enforce the reduced limit. Slow down in good time and keep your distance from the vehicle in front.

27. D - Powered mobility scooters

Motorways mustn’t be used by pedestrians, cyclists, motorcycles under 50 cc, certain slow-moving vehicles without permission, and powered wheelchairs/mobility scooters.

28. B - Look much further ahead than you would on other roads

Traffic on motorways usually travels faster than on other roads. You need to be looking further ahead to give yourself more time to react to any hazard that may develop.

29. A - Stay in the left-hand lane

When you've just joined a motorway, stay in the left-hand lane long enough to get used to the higher speeds of motorway traffic before considering overtaking.

30. A - When you're overtaking

The right-hand lane of the motorway is for overtaking. Sometimes you may be directed into a right-hand lane as a result of roadworks or a traffic incident. This will be indicated by signs or officers directing the traffic.

31. B - When you're stopping in an emergency

Don’t use the hard shoulder for stopping unless it's an emergency. If you want to stop for any other reason, go to the next exit or service area.

32. B - Move to the left and reduce your speed to 50 mph

You must obey these signs even if there appear to be no problems ahead. There could be queuing traffic or another hazard that you can't see yet.

33. A - When you're signalled to do so by traffic signals

You must stop if overhead gantry signs show a red cross above every lane on the motorway. If any of the other lanes doesn't show a red cross, you may move into that lane and continue if it's safe to do so.

34. C - Adjust your speed or change lane if you can do so safely

Plan well ahead when approaching a slip road. If you see traffic joining the motorway, be prepared to adjust your speed or move to another lane if it's safe to do so. This can help the flow of traffic joining the motorway, especially at peak times.

35. B - Keep to the left-hand lane unless you're overtaking

You should normally travel in the left-hand lane unless you're overtaking a slower-moving vehicle. When you've finished overtaking, move back into the left-hand lane, but don’t cut across in front of the vehicle that you’ve overtaken.

36. A - When in queues and traffic to your right is moving more slowly than you are

Never overtake on the left, unless the traffic is moving in queues and the queue on your right is moving more slowly than the one you're in.

37. A - In cases of emergency or breakdown

On some motorways, emergency areas are built at the side of the carriageway. If you break down, try to get your vehicle into the emergency area where there's an emergency telephone. The phone connects directly to a control centre. Before rejoining the motorway, you must call the control centre - a lane may need to be closed to allow you to rejoin safely.

38. D - Stop and direct anyone on a motorway

Traffic officers don't have enforcement powers but are able to stop and direct people on motorways and some ‘A’ class roads. They operate in England and Wales and work in partnership with the police at incidents, providing a highly trained and visible service. They're recognised by an orange-and-yellow jacket and their vehicle has yellow-and-black markings.

39. A - You must not travel in this lane

At certain times, the hard shoulder will be open as a running lane. However, a red cross above the hard shoulder shows that it is not open as a running lane and should only be used for emergencies and breakdowns.

40. C - The hard shoulder can be used as a running lane

A mandatory speed-limit sign above the hard shoulder shows that this part of the road can be used as a running lane between junctions. You must stay within the speed limit. Look out for vehicles that may have broken down and could be blocking the hard shoulder.

41. A - By using variable speed limits

You must follow the mandatory signs on the gantries above motorway lanes, including the hard shoulder. Variable speed limits help keep the traffic moving and also help to prevent bunching.

42. B - Variable speed limits

Congestion can be reduced by keeping traffic at a constant speed. At busy times, maximum speed limits are displayed on overhead gantries. These can be varied quickly, depending on the amount of traffic. By keeping to a constant speed on busy sections of motorway, overall journey times are normally improved.

43. D - In an emergency or breakdown

You shouldn't normally stop on a motorway, but there may be occasions when you need to do so. If your vehicle breaks down or there's an emergency, stop on the hard shoulder and use the emergency telephones to call for assistance.

44. D - 70 mph

The national speed limit for a car or motorcycle on a motorway is 70 mph. Lower speed limits may be in force; for example, at roadworks. Variable speed limits also operate in some areas when the motorway is very busy. Cars or motorcycles towing trailers are subject to a lower speed limit.

45. B - Well away from the carriageway

When you're on the hard shoulder, you're at risk of being injured by motorway traffic. The safest place to wait is away from the carriageway, but near enough to see the emergency services arriving.

46. D - Stop and wait

A red cross signal above all lanes means you must stop and wait. Don't change lanes and don't try to continue any further along the motorway.

47. B - The hard shoulder is for emergency or breakdown use only

A red cross above the hard shoulder shows that it's closed as a running lane and should only be used for emergencies or breakdowns. On some motorways, the hard shoulder may be used as a running lane at busy times. This will be shown by a mandatory speed limit on the gantry above the hard shoulder.

48. B - Use all the lanes, including the hard shoulder

You must obey mandatory speed-limit signs above motorway lanes, including the hard shoulder. In this case, you can use the hard shoulder as a running lane but you should look for any vehicles that may have broken down and may be blocking the hard shoulder.

49. C - At the nearest service area

If you feel tired, stop at the nearest service area. If that's too far away, leave the motorway at the next exit and find a safe place to stop. You mustn't stop on the carriageway or hard shoulder of a motorway except in an emergency, when in a traffic queue, or when signalled to do so by a police officer, a traffic officer or traffic signals. Plan your journey so that you have regular rest stops.

50. D - Use the emergency telephone

To rejoin the carriageway from an emergency area, you must use the emergency telephone and follow the operator's advice. A lane may have to be closed so that you can rejoin the carriageway safely.

51. C - Build up speed on the hard shoulder before looking for a safe gap in the traffic

To rejoin a motorway from the hard shoulder, you first need to build up speed on the hard shoulder. You can then look for a safe gap in the traffic in the left-hand lane. Watch for traffic that may be returning from a lane on the right into the left-hand lane.